RAMAYANAM: BALA KANDA

Ramayanam means the life journey of Sri Rama. He lived for eleven thousand Years. He lived one crore and four lakhs years ago. Ramayana was written Contemporarily by Valmiki Maharshi. He was advised by Narada Maharishi to write Ramayana.

Valmiki questioned as to who was there possessing all the sixteen good qualities Possessed by Chandrudu (Moon). Narada explained all those good qualities of Rama:

1. Souseelyudu: One who is at the top position by caste, money, education, and

Social status, but talks politely and with good mind to others, who might Belong to any lower level.

2. Veeryawan: One who is valorous and who completes his good job, even in spite

Of any strong or big hurdle comes in the way.

3. Panditudu: Having high knowledge, who is able to speak suitable good sayings

To the society willingly.

4. Pratibhavantudu: One who knows anything completely and can explain his opinion

In true spirit.

5. Vidhvamsudu: One who learns anything completely by its meaning, essence,

Usage, and purpose.

6. Krutagyudu: One who takes the other’s help, in turn helps him without finding

Faults in him.

7. Mahatmudu: Without any aspirings, one with good mind, does deeds for the

Better of all the people of the society. (Ex: Mahatma Gandhiji).

8. Atmavan: Man with good mind and never causes worry to others. If he has to

Punish others, he punishes the body, but not the mind.

9. Asuyarahitudu: Man without envy. Jealousy develops into envy. Describing

Other's good qualities as defects is envy.

10. Jitakrodhudu: Krodham is more severe than anger. One who defeats his own

Krodham is Jitakrodhudu. Anger ends as the time passes, but krodham ends With revenge.

11. Hitabhashi: One who speaks sweet language that others feel pleasing.

12. Mitabhashi: One who can express more information in less words.

13. Satyavan: Who speaks only the truth and stands for it. Rama went to forest to

Make his father's assurance true.

14. Charitravan: One who possesses a good character and good back history.

15. Priyadarsanudu: One who looks peaceful and cheerful. Whoever saw Rama felt

Very happy, forgetting all his troubles.

16. Roopavan: One who looks handsome with an attractive body.

Narada then narrated the Sankshepa Ramayanam within one hundred slokas to Valmiki. Later, Valmiki happened to see a bird-hunter killing a male bird and the Female bird crying. So, he scolded him; the words, one by one, formed into a Sloka (stanza).

Then came Brahma Deva to Valmiki Ashram. With all his obedience, Valmiki Respectfully gave hospitality to Brahma Deva. The sloka spelt by Valmiki against The bird-hunter was differently explained by Brahma Deva: that it was the Essence of Ramayanam, with the grace of the Goddess Saraswathi.

Then, Brahma gave the boon that Valmiki would have the vision with ability to View both physical and mental behaviors of each character of Ramayanam.

After the departure of Brahma Deva, Valmiki sat, facing the East sacredly, and Started writing Ramayanam. He completed it in twenty-four thousand slokas in six Divisions (Kandas). They are: Balakaanda, Ayodhya kaanda, Aranya kaanda, Kishkinda kaanda, Sundara kaanda, and Yuddha kaanda.

Ravana had already taken a boon from Brahma Deva that he could not be killed by Any of the Devatas, animals, nature, and all except human beings and monkeys, as After all both couldn’t kill him. On the other hand, Lord Vishnu stated that he Would take birth as the four sons of Dasaradha Maharaja, to kill Ravana and other Rakshasas and to illustrate to human beings good behavior as Rama and brothers. Brahma Deva ordered all the Gods to go to earth and give birth to crores and Crores of Vanaras with strength and divine potential, so as to help Rama in the War to be waged against Ravana. So, Vanaras were born.

Dasaradha Maharaja, the sixty-thousand-year-old Emperor of Kosala kingdom, had Three wives, namely Kausalya, Sumitra, and Kaikeyi. But he had no children. So, He solemnised Putra Kameshti Yagam. He wanted to be blessed with sons. Yagna Purusha appeared and gave the golden bowl with payasam to Dasaradha. He Distributed payasam to his three wives.

Then were born four sons: one to Kausalya, two to Sumitra, and one to Kaikeyi. Then Dasaradha requested his pandit Sri Vasista Maharshi to name his sons. He Named the eldest son as Rama, taking ‘Ra’ from Narayana and ‘ma’ from

Namassivaya. Whoever spells the name ‘Rama’ gets energy, braveness, and Confidence. Vasista named the other three boys as Laxmana, Bharata, and Satrughna. It is the best custom to get children named by a Pandit or elderly Person of the family. The four sons of Dasaradha were growing up. Rama was very Beautiful.

Whenever he found time in the court-hall, Dasaradha Maharaja used to call Rama. Rama used to go and stand before his father quietly, but never questioned why or What. His father ordered and he obeyed—that’s it: Pitruvakya Paripalana, at the Age of three years. Then at his twelfth year, Rama looked very handsome, with Long hair, standing tall, and his hands stretched down up to his knees. While he Was walking, Dasaradha used to stare at him with Putrotsaham and remembered his Own stature resembling Rama at youth. Rama and the brothers were educated under Vasista Maharshi. He taught them all that was needed for princes, including Archery and horse riding. They grew up to sixteen years.

Then came Viswamitra Maharshi to Ayodhya. He requested that Dasaradha might send Rama with him to guard his yagam from Rakshasas at Divya-asram. Dasaradha said That Rama was too young and so, he himself would go with him. But Vasista Advised Dasaradha that he taught only Sastras (archery) to Rama and that Viswamitra, who knows a hundred Astras, would teach them all to Rama if sent with Him. Then Dasaradha sent Rama and Laxmana with Viswamitra.

Rama went in obedience to his father’s order (Pitruvakya paripalana). Laxmana Followed Rama with brotherly respect (Bhatru-maryada). Viswamitra taught two Astras, namely, Bala and Ati-Bala, to Rama and Laxmana. Sastras being arrows,

Astras mean the mantras to be recited for each arrow. Rama battered Tataki, the Ogre, on the way in the forest.

One night, Viswamitra, Rama, and Laxmana took rest at Kamasramam. The next Morning, Viswamitra, after completing his morning needs, woke up Rama, reciting “Kausalya Supraja Rama…”. This is the Suprabhatam sung every morning for Lord Venkateswara at Tirumala at present, which is an age-old custom.

Then, Viswamitra, Rama, and Laxmana went to Siddhasram. There, Rama and Laxmana Learnt all other Astras from Viswamitra.

Then, Kousika (Viswamitra) Yagam was successfully completed, as Rama and Laxmana Guarded the yagam by killing the ogres. Rama shot Agneyastram on Subahudu and all His ogres to kill them, and Manavastram on Marichudu and all his ogres to throw Them away into the sea.

After successful completion of Kousika Yagam, Rama, Laxmana, and Viswamitra left Siddhasram for Gouthama Maharshi Asram. On the way, they crossed the river Ganga And entered the city of Girivrajapuram. The place was full of green trees, with Flowers, vegetables, and fruits. So, Rama asked Viswamitra as to why that place Was so pleasant. So, Viswamitra explained the details.

There was a king called Kusaraju ruling that area. He had four sons, namely: Kusambudu, Kusanadhudu, Adhurtarajasudu, and Vasuraju. They grew up as young Princes. So, the king asked his sons to construct each one city. They did so. This city was built by the fourth prince, amidst five hills surrounded by the

Shona river. The river appeared like a floating flower garland. Because of that River, the land amidst the five hills became fertile land. So, it was beautiful And pleasant.

As Rama attained the age of marriage, Viswamitra explained further details: Kusanadhudu, the second son of Kusaraju, mating Ghrutachi, the angel, gave birth To a hundred daughters. They, having grown up, became young beautiful girls. All Of them were playing on a hill in Girivrajapuram. “Play” means to play music on Sitar and sing songs.

At that moment, the Air God appeared in human form and said that all the girls Were very beautiful, but they, being human girls, would become old and lose their Youth and beauty. And so he proposed to give them divineness so that they could Maintain their youth and beauty forever if they married him. So, they replied All at a time, without any discussion among themselves, calling him a bad-minded Man; that he needed not give them any divineness, and that they could smash his Divinity by virtue of their Tapo-shakti (meditation-energy), but their father Taught them patience. They stated that he should not have asked them directly; He must have asked their father; that they would marry whoever was suggested by Their father. So, the Air God turned angry and reduced their breathing. Then They became weak and reported the matter to their father. He felt happy with his Daughters using their patience and went out to search for a suitable son-in-law.

Chuli, a Maharshi, was served by an angel and her daughter for several years. So, being pleased with their service, he asked them what they wanted. The Daughter, Somada, requested him to give her a good son, even without

Relationship with the Maharshi, but of him. By his blessings, she had a son. He was named Brahmadattudu. He grew and attained meditation power.

Kusanadhudu went to Brahmadattudu, explained about his daughters, and proposed Their marriage with him. He agreed and followed Kusanadhudu. Then, Kusanadhudu Performed Kanyadanam of all the daughters, one by one, to Brahmadattudu, who in Turn took the bridal hands into his hand one by one. So, the girls lost their Weakness and got full breathing by his touch. Their mother-in-law, Somada, Received each girl and said that their father brought them up with good Behaviour and patience; that he was a great person.

Then, Kusanadhudu requested a Rishi for a son. Due to his blessings, a son was Born by the name Gadi. Later, Gadi gave birth to a son called Kousikudu. He Afterwards gained meditation power and got his name changed to Viswamitrudu. By Reading or hearing this story, girls get good and strong willpower.

Then, Viswamitra took Rama and Laxmana to Gouthama Maharshi Asram. No one was There. Viswamitra took Rama inside the parnasala (big hut). Finding there a heap Of ashes, Viswamitra explained Ahalya's story to Rama. She was cursed by her Husband Gouthama Maharshi for the sin committed together with Indra. As such, She was in meditation (tapassu) for thousands of years under the ashes. Then, The air that touched Rama passed over the ashes, which were blown off, and Ahalya got up, being released from the curse as pronounced by her husband. She Looked pure and empyreal. So, Rama revered and saluted her feet, she being elder. Then Ahalya revered and saluted Rama's feet, as he was the cause of her release From the curse. Gouthama Maharshi came and took away Ahalya after thousands of

Years of separation.

Later, Viswamitra took Rama and Laxmana to Mithila Nagaram, stating he would Show Siva Dhanussu. It was in the empire of Janaka Maharaja. Lord Siva gave his Dhanussu to Devarathudu, the ancestor of Janaka Maharaja. Janakudu and Satanandudu, The pandit, welcomed Viswamitra and enquired about Rama and Laxmana. Informing That the young boys were the sons of Dasaradha Maharaja, Viswamitra asked Janakudu To show Siva Dhanussu to Rama. Janaka got the manjusha (box) containing Siva Dhanussu on a trolley pulled by five hundred soldiers.

Janaka explained that so many Devatas, kings, and others tried to marry Sita as Announced by Janaka, but failed even to lift the Siva Dhanussu. Some kings Attacked Janaka for Sita and Siva Dhanussu, but were defeated.

With the permission of Viswamitra, Rama touched, lifted, tied its string, and Stretched to shoot Siva Dhanussu, which broke into two.

So, Janaka Maharaja happily said to Viswamitra that he wished to solemnize the Marriage of Sita with Rama. Viswamitra passed on the proposal to Rama. He said That his father had to decide his marriage.

So, Janaka Maharaja sent his ministers and Pandits with all gifts to Ayodhya to Convey the message to Dasaradha Maharaja. In turn, Dasaradha Maharaja consulted His Pandits and Ministers and went to Mithila with all of them.

With all respect, Janaka Maharaja received Dasaradha and then proposed the

Marriages of:

* Sita with Rama

* Urmila (his own daughter) with Laxmana

* Mandavi (his younger brother’s daughter) with Bharata

* Srutakeerthi (his younger brother’s daughter) with Satrughna

Duly taking the advice of his ministers and Pandits, Dasaradha accepted the Proposal.

Viswamitra, Vasista, and other pandits solemnized the four marriages on the same Dais. Then Viswamitra went away to the Himalayas.

Dasaradha, with all his sons, daughters-in-law, and others, started back to Ayodhya. On the way, Parasurama met them angrily, questioning how Rama was so Strong as to have broken the Siva Dhanussu. He challenged Rama to aim the Vishnu Dhanussu that was with him. Sri Rama took the bow, tightened its string, and Inserted an arrow. Rama asked him whether to annihilate Parasurama's legs or his Own built Urdhva Lokas. In turn, he requested Rama not to hit his legs. So, Rama Annihilated his Urdhva Lokas. Then, Parasurama realised that Sri Rama was an Incarnation of Lord Vishnu.

Then, Dasaradha and all others went to Ayodhya. There, Kausalya, Sumitra, and Kaikeyi received Sita and the other daughters-in-law. First, they were taken Into the Puja Mandiram as per our sampradayam (custom).